

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a leaflet about elective courses:

Elective Courses for Secondary Schools

I. Firefighting

Firefighting is one of the most dangerous jobs in the world. It requires complete discipline and attention to the professional standards necessary to fight fires, handle hazardous materials and conduct search-and-rescue operations. Students will become familiar with the procedures, equipment, and technologies used by current fire departments. This course challenges students academically, mentally and physically.

II. Media Technology and Film Production

This course offers students an opportunity to study all aspects of video and media production, from planning and writing for production to operating studio and editing equipment. Students practise various methods of gathering news and information from individuals, research and online resources. In addition, students are introduced to the principles of film production.

III. Fisheries and Wildlife Management

The Fisheries and Wildlife Management course offers instruction in the identification and management of wildlife and aquatics and of their habitats. Content will also include the issues related to endangered species and organizations that protect fisheries and wildlife.

IV. Business Law

Students examine the foundations of the local legal system and learn the rights and responsibilities of citizens. Students gain practical knowledge and life skills by exploring concepts related to laws governing business and individuals. Focus areas include contracts, consumer protection, criminal law, employment law and careers in the legal profession.

Your school is planning to introduce a new course for senior students in the next academic year. As members of the Student Union, you are meeting to discuss which course you would recommend. You may want to talk about:

- how the four courses can benefit students
- what difficulties may be encountered if these courses are introduced
- which course would be the most popular among students
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Which subject do you like the most?
2. Which is your least favourite subject?
3. Are you happy with the courses offered in your school?
4. In your experience, are core subjects easier than electives?
5. What criteria do you consider before choosing an elective?
6. What are the pros and cons of requiring students to take core subjects?
7. Which elective do you think should be made into a compulsory subject?
8. Have electives made your learning experience more well-rounded?